

Man loses ₹13 lakh in hotel booking scam

A 63-year-old man from Mithakhali recently lost Rs 13 lakh in a hotel booking scam while planning a trip to Ambaji, a popular pilgrim place. His experience highlights the clever tactics scammers use to manipulate unsuspecting individuals. It all started in March when the man was looking for a hotel near the Ambaji temple. After Googling options, he came across a phone number for a hotel. When he called, a person on the other end of the line, claiming to be hotel staff, asked for an advance payment of Rs 10,000 to confirm the booking. Trusting the conversation, the man made the payment through a UPI transaction. <https://tinyurl.com/wukm7muc>

New jumped deposit scam is targeting UPI users with fake transactions

Technology has definitely made communication and online transactions very easy. There are plenty of UPI applications which allow users to transfer money within a few seconds. Looking at the convenience, the scammers are always on the watch to find out new ways to defraud people. Recently, the authorities have warned about the rising Jumped Deposit Scam targeting the UPI users. For the unversed, in this particular scam, the fraudsters often deposit money to the victim's amount to win the trust and then trick them by making them transfer large amount of money. <https://tinyurl.com/2p89p8d3>

Goa man loses ₹7 lakh in task-based scam

In a shocking case, a man from Bicholim, Goa, lost Rs 7 lakh in just six days after falling victim to a task-based scam. The scam, which operated through WhatsApp and Telegram groups, used a mix of trust-building tactics, simple tasks, and escalating demands for money to deceive the victim. Unfortunately, scams like these are becoming increasingly common, targeting people with promises of quick and easy returns. It all started when the victim was added to a WhatsApp group. Initially, the tasks seemed harmless: follow a few channels and share screenshots with a person named Chaya. For completing these tasks, the victim received small payments of Rs 150 via UPI, which created a sense of trust and legitimacy. <https://tinyurl.com/3ydra2k4>

Engineer loses ₹98,000 after receiving fake UPI registration text

We've all received unexpected messages on our phones, but most of us ignore them, thinking it's just another spam. However, one engineer from Badlapur learned the hard way that not every message is harmless. On November 13, he fell victim to a scam that cost him Rs 98,000. It all began when the 39-year-old engineer received a sudden text message from an unknown number. The message read, "You have initiated the registration of UPI payments on PhonePe. If this is not done by you, please report it to PhonePe." Confused, the engineer tried to figure out what was going on. As he was still processing the message, he received another notification—an OTP sent to his phone, linked with his Aadhaar account, reports The Free Press Journal. <https://tinyurl.com/dnsz2jkn>

A fake app circulating on WhatsApp targets UPI users, steals money

If you use UPI apps for your daily transactions, this is a warning you can't ignore. The Tamil Nadu Police have uncovered a new phishing scam where fraudsters are using a fake app to steal money and sensitive information. The app, disguised as the "PM Kisan Yojna" application, is being circulated on WhatsApp to target unsuspecting users. Once downloaded, it can compromise your device's security and give scammers access to your UPI accounts. The fake app tricks users into thinking it is linked to the popular PM Kisan Yojna scheme. Once installed, it requests permissions to access SMS and device data. <https://tinyurl.com/4dxye6rd>